

GEO Analysis Report

Generative Engine Optimization Audit for Retail Calculus

Website	https://retailcalculus.com
Analysis Date	May 30, 2026
GEO Score	15/100 — Needs Attention



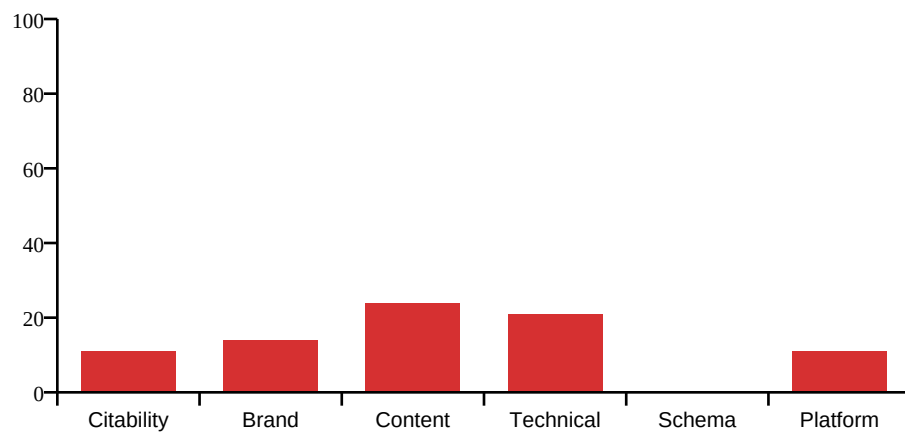
Needs Attention

Executive Summary

Retail Calculus is a B2B SaaS company with a genuine vertical-software story — bolt-on, cloud-hosted retail operations modules for furniture and big-ticket retailers, co-founded by a former Crate & Barrel Chief Transformation Officer — and it is essentially invisible to every AI search platform that matters. The site is a single static HTML file last modified in September 2019 (~520 words), with no sitemap, no robots.txt, no schema markup of any type, an empty meta description, and a copyright date of 2016. AI crawlers that don't execute JavaScript receive only 'Loading...' from the page. The three highest-leverage fixes — creating an llms.txt file, adding Organization schema, and registering on Crunchbase and G2 — require no site rebuild and could lift the GEO score from 15 to 35 within 30 days. The company's single strongest GEO asset — co-founder Ed Rennemann's documented Crate & Barrel CTO background — is nowhere structured for AI consumption.

GEO Score Breakdown

Component	Score	Weight	Weighted
AI Citability & Visibility	11/100	25%	2.8
Brand Authority Signals	14/100	20%	2.8
Content Quality & E-E-A-T	24/100	20%	4.8
Technical Foundations	21/100	15%	3.1
Structured Data	0/100	10%	0.0
Platform Optimization	11/100	10%	1.1
OVERALL	15/100	100%	15



AI Platform Readiness

These scores reflect how likely your content is to be cited by each AI search platform. A score below 50 indicates significant barriers to citation on that platform.



AI Platform	Score	Status
Google AI Overviews	12/100	Needs Attention
ChatGPT Web Search	11/100	Needs Attention
Perplexity AI	10/100	Needs Attention
Google Gemini	12/100	Needs Attention
Bing Copilot	10/100	Needs Attention

AI Crawler Access Status

Blocking AI crawlers prevents AI platforms from citing your content. The table below shows which AI crawlers can currently access your site.

Crawler	Platform	Status	Recommendation
GPTBot	ChatGPT / OpenAI	Unknown — No robots.txt	Create robots.txt with explicit Allow: / directive for GPTBot
OAI-SearchBot	ChatGPT Search	Unknown — No robots.txt	Create robots.txt with explicit Allow: / for OAI-SearchBot
ClaudeBot	Claude / Anthropic	Unknown — No robots.txt	Create robots.txt with explicit Allow: / for ClaudeBot
PerplexityBot	Perplexity AI	Unknown — No robots.txt	Create robots.txt with explicit Allow: / for PerplexityBot
Google-Extended	Google Gemini / Bard	Unknown — No robots.txt	Create robots.txt with explicit Allow: / for Google-Extended
Amazonbot	Amazon Alexa	Unknown — No robots.txt	Add explicit Allow: / in robots.txt
Bytespider	ByteDance / TikTok AI	Unknown — No robots.txt	Add to robots.txt with Allow or Block based on preference
CCBot	Common Crawl (AI training data)	Unknown — No robots.txt	Allow CCBot to enable AI training data inclusion
Applebot-Extended	Apple Intelligence	Unknown — No robots.txt	Create robots.txt with explicit Allow: / for Applebot-Extended
Cohere-ai	Cohere AI	Unknown — No robots.txt	Add explicit Allow: / in robots.txt

Key Findings

[CRITICAL] SPA JavaScript barrier — all content invisible to non-JS AI crawlers

The hero carousel (jquery.superslides) means crawlers that don't execute JavaScript receive only 'Loading...' as page body. This negates all other content fixes until resolved. Workaround: add a noscript block containing full site text content as an immediate stopgap.

[CRITICAL] No robots.txt, no sitemap.xml, no llms.txt — zero crawler infrastructure

/robots.txt returns a hosting-provider parking page (IONOS). /sitemap.xml returns 404. /llms.txt returns 404. No mechanism exists for AI crawlers to understand permissions, discover content, or receive structured company information.

[CRITICAL] Zero schema markup — no entity identity for AI models

No Organization, LocalBusiness, SoftwareApplication, Person, WebSite, or any other schema type exists anywhere in the HTML. AI models cannot resolve 'Retail Calculus' as a distinct company entity without structured data. The brand name also collides with a common generic phrase ('retail calculus') used in unrelated industry writing.

[CRITICAL] Meta description empty, title tag contains no keywords (15 chars)

Title tag: 'Retail Calculus' (15 chars, brand name only). Meta description: meta description tag with empty content attribute — empty string confirmed. No Open Graph tags, no Twitter Card tags. AI indexing systems use these as primary content signals; their absence removes the most basic AI-readable content anchors.

[CRITICAL] Google footprint: 1 URL indexed for entire company and 6 products

site:retailcalculus.com returns exactly 1 result — the homepage only. Six named products (Prime, Vendis, Sarcio, Partum, Optimus, Scout) have zero individually crawlable pages. The SPA anchor-only navigation means no AI platform can discover or index individual product content.

[HIGH] Brand name disambiguation risk — 'retail calculus' is a common noun phrase

The phrase 'retail calculus' appears in unrelated contexts: Rolex purchase discussions, retail analytics articles, academic writing. Without Wikipedia, Wikidata, or schema sameAs links, AI models frequently interpret the phrase as a concept rather than a company name — suppressing citation probability across all platforms.

[HIGH] Zero brand presence on AI-cited third-party platforms

No Wikipedia article, no Wikidata entity, no Crunchbase profile, no G2 listing, no Capterra listing, no Trustpilot reviews. Furniture Wizard has 678 Trustpilot reviews; STORIS has named customer community. Retail Calculus does not appear on any platform AI models use for B2B software entity verification.

[HIGH] Content citability: no passage scores above 47/100 — nothing AI-citable

Passage-level scoring: highest block is the founder credentials section (47/100 — 'Former Chief Transformation Officer at Crate and Barrel'). No block reaches the 70+ threshold for AI citation readiness. No statistics, no case study outcomes, no customer names, no comparison data.

[HIGH] Site last modified September 2019 — 6+ year freshness penalty

HTTP Last-Modified header: Thu, 12 Sep 2019. Combined with '© 2016' copyright footer, the page presents maximum staleness signals. AI models weight recent content; this site has no mechanism to signal currency. Content freshness is one of three primary Perplexity citation factors.

[HIGH] www vs non-www canonical duplicate — 4 URL variants all return HTTP 200

retailcalculus.com, www.retailcalculus.com, /index.html, and www/index.html all serve identical content (confirmed same ETag). No canonical tag exists. This fragments whatever link authority exists across 4 URL variants and signals infrastructure neglect to crawlers.

[MEDIUM] E-E-A-T score: 37/100 — strong credentials, zero activation

Co-founder Ed Rennemann (former Crate & Barrel CTO) is the site's strongest trust asset. It is buried below 'Incorporated in 2016' in the About section with no byline markup, no Person schema, and no LinkedIn link. The Crate & Barrel credential appears nowhere in the page's machine-readable signals.

[MEDIUM] No privacy policy or terms of service

No privacy policy page, no terms of service, no cookie disclosure. This is a GDPR/CCPA compliance gap and a trust signal failure. Enterprise retail buyers with legal review requirements will not engage a vendor with no visible legal documentation.

[MEDIUM] 6+ security header failures + deprecated Google Maps API

HSTS, CSP, X-Frame-Options, X-Content-Type-Options, and Referrer-Policy are all absent. <http://maps.google.com/maps/api/js?sensor=true> loads over HTTP (deprecated 2012 endpoint, blocked by modern browsers as mixed content). Raw IP address exposed in HTML source comments.

Prioritized Action Plan

Quick Wins (This Week)

High impact, low effort — can be implemented immediately.

1. Create /llms.txt with structured product and company summaries — deployable in 1 hour with zero site changes; immediately readable by ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Bing Copilot crawlers
2. Create /robots.txt with explicit Allow: / for all major AI crawlers (GPTBot, ClaudeBot, PerplexityBot, Google-Extended, OAI-SearchBot, Applebot-Extended)
3. Add Organization + LocalBusiness JSON-LD schema to the HTML head — address, phone, and founder data already in the HTML; enables Knowledge Panel, AI entity recognition, and all platform citation
4. Fix meta title to 57-char keyword-rich version and add 155-char meta description — 15-minute HTML edit with immediate impact on all 5 AI platforms
5. Update copyright '© 2016' to '© 2016-2026' and add canonical tag to resolve 4-way URL duplicate — 15-minute fix
6. Add canonical tag pointing to <https://retailcalculus.com/> and configure www to non-www 301 redirect in .htaccess
7. Create free Crunchbase and LinkedIn Company Page profiles — establishes entity verification nodes AI models use for brand disambiguation

Medium-Term Improvements (This Month)

Significant impact, moderate effort — requires content or technical changes.

1. Add Person JSON-LD for both founders — Ed Rennemann's Crate & Barrel CTO credential is the single strongest AI-citable authority signal available; it must be in machine-readable schema
2. Add SoftwareApplication JSON-LD for all 6 products using @graph format — transforms product names from unstructured text into structured software entities AI models can cite
3. Claim Google Business Profile at 168 Franklin Corner Road, Lawrenceville NJ — fastest path to Google Gemini ecosystem recognition and local Knowledge Panel
4. Create G2 and Capterra company profiles; solicit 3-5 customer reviews — Perplexity and ChatGPT weight review platform presence heavily for B2B software entities
5. Publish 2-minute Vendis product walkthrough video on a Retail Calculus YouTube channel — creates a Google-owned entity link Gemini can use to confirm brand existence
6. Add security headers via .htaccess (HSTS, X-Content-Type-Options, X-Frame-Options, Referrer-Policy) and fix Google Maps HTTP to HTTPS

Strategic Initiatives (This Quarter)

Long-term competitive advantage — requires ongoing investment.

1. Build 6 individual product pages (/products/prime, /products/vendis, etc.) with 500+ words, FAQ blocks, and product-specific schema — multiplies indexed URL count from 1 to 7 and enables per-product AI citation

2. Publish the founder origin story: 'How a Crate & Barrel CTO built the software he wished existed' — 800-word practitioner narrative that is uniquely AI-citable and no competitor can replicate
3. Register Retail Calculus LLC on Wikidata with founder, founding date, location, and sameAs links — ties all entity signals into the global knowledge graph used by ChatGPT and Gemini
4. Publish one confirmed customer case study (American Sale is an implicit customer per job postings) with named retailer and quantified outcome metrics
5. Launch 6 foundational SEO/GEO content articles targeting: 'furniture retail software', 'PIM for furniture retailers', 'retail digital transformation', 'omnichannel inventory management retail', 'furniture sales associate tools', 'in-home delivery scheduling software'

Appendix: Methodology

This GEO audit was conducted on 2026-05-30 analyzing <https://retailcalculus.com>. The analysis evaluated the website across six dimensions: AI Citability & Visibility (25%), Brand Authority Signals (20%), Content Quality & E-E-A-T (20%), Technical Foundations (15%), Structured Data (10%), and Platform Optimization (10%).

Platforms assessed: Google AI Overviews, ChatGPT Web Search, Perplexity AI, Google Gemini, Bing Copilot

Standards referenced: Google Search Quality Rater Guidelines (Dec 2025), Schema.org specification, Core Web Vitals (2026 thresholds), llms.txt emerging standard, RSL 1.0 licensing framework

Glossary

Term	Definition
GEO	Generative Engine Optimization — optimizing content for AI search citation
AIO	AI Overviews — Google's AI-generated answer boxes in search results
E-E-A-T	Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trustworthiness
SSR	Server-Side Rendering — generating HTML on the server for crawler access
CWV	Core Web Vitals — Google's page experience metrics (LCP, INP, CLS)
INP	Interaction to Next Paint — responsiveness metric (replaced FID March 2024)
JSON-LD	JavaScript Object Notation for Linked Data — preferred structured data format
sameAs	Schema.org property linking an entity to its profiles on other platforms
llms.txt	Proposed standard file for guiding AI systems about site content
IndexNow	Protocol for instantly notifying search engines of content changes

This report was generated by the GEO-SEO Claude Code Analysis Tool. Scores and recommendations are based on automated analysis and industry benchmarks. Results should be validated with platform-specific testing.